

Wes Henderson

Staff Systems Engineer

whendersonii@gmail.com

(210) 589-0628

Summary

Automation-focused Systems Engineer with 10+ years of experience in designing, integrating, and optimizing scalable infrastructure in cloud-native environments. Strong Linux advocate with deep technical acumen in automation, DevOps, and systems architecture. Skilled in mentoring, documentation, and fostering cross-functional collaboration. Proven ability to deliver innovative solutions that drive cost savings, reduce incident response times, and elevate organizational resilience.

Skills

DevOps and Tooling: CI/CD Pipelines, Automation, Configuration Management, Infrastructure as Code (IaC), Immutable Infrastructure, Microservices, Containerization, Jenkins, ArgoCD, GitHub Actions

Infrastructure, Platforms, and Management: Linux, Kubernetes (EKS & GKE), AWS, GCP, Helm, Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible, Chef, Puppet, Docker, Apache, Nginx, MySQL, PostgreSQL

Observability: Grafana, Prometheus, Splunk

Systems Analysis: Incident Response, Root Cause Analysis, Technical Research, Troubleshooting, Problem Solving

Leadership: Mentoring, Documentation, Communication, Adaptability, Generalist, Cross-Functional Collaboration

Programming and Scripting: Python, Bash, PowerShell

Relevant Experience

Salesforce

Lead Systems Engineer

November 2019 - April 2025

- Spearheaded the 'Bring Your Own Key' (BYOK) initiative, securing \$6M in recurring revenue and satisfying key enterprise customer requirements.
- Discovered and resolved critical cloud misconfigurations, saving \$3M annually in AWS infrastructure costs.
- Orchestrated the onboarding of multiple business units to Kubernetes with zero service disruptions.

- Designed and implemented an extensible CLI tool for managing asynchronous jobs, significantly reducing MTTR and boosting operational visibility.
- Developed a reusable SRE tooling pipeline that reduced tribal knowledge dependencies and improved incident recovery workflows.
- Facilitated alignment and collaboration across multiple teams to deliver infrastructure projects on time and within budget.
- Led incident response and resolution efforts during on-call rotations.
- Investigated and remediated system vulnerabilities.

TrueAbility

Deployment Engineer

February 2018 - November 2019

- Designed and launched custom exams for major clients including Google, Elastic, Chef, SUSE, Linux Foundation, and VMWare.
- Fully automated the provisioning and grading of exam environments across diverse tech stacks, rapidly adapting to client needs.
- Supported pre-sales efforts by answering technical inquiries and delivering customized product demonstrations tailored to client needs.
- Owned all post-sale account management activities, serving as the primary point of contact to drive customer success, retention, and growth.
- Expanded company offerings into recruitment-focused products.
- Mentored junior engineers and built documentation/playbooks, reducing escalations and supporting career development within the team.
- Wrote Ansible playbooks and brought all internal infrastructure under configuration management.
- Contributed to the internal codebase for exam delivery and associated tooling.

Rackspace Hosting

DevOps Engineer

May 2013 - December 2017

- Delivered 2–3 custom AWS deployments per week, adhering to compliance standards (e.g., PCI, HIPAA).
- Authored a Python-based automation framework to accelerate builds, cutting deployment failure rates in half.
- Enhanced customer satisfaction by creating custom tools in Bash and Python that streamlined onboarding and troubleshooting.

- Supported knowledge sharing through active contributions to internal wikis and public blog content.
- Acted as a technical liaison to educate clients on distributed systems and DevOps best practices.

Certifications

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect
 - Red Hat Red Hat Certified Engineer (RHCE)
 - Red Hat Red Hat Certified System Administrator (RHCSA)
 - Linux Professional Institute LPIC-1
 - CompTIA Linux+
 - CompTIA Security+
 - CompTIA Network+
 - CompTIA A+
-
- 2017
 - 2016
 - 2013
 - 2012
 - 2012
 - 2010
 - 2010
 - 2008
-
- AWS-ASA-29789
 - 130-119-274
 - 130-119-274
 - LPI000250530
 - COMP001007825623
 - COMP001007825623
 - COMP001007825623
 - COMP001007825623

Education

Northwest Vista College - San Antonio, Texas

Associate of Applied Science in Computer Forensics ' — 4.0 GPA

- Marketable Skills Achievement Award: Linux RHCT
- Marketable Skills Achievement Award: Information Security & Assurance

Publications

1. Henderson, Wes (December 19, 2015). [The Anatomy of an SSH Connection](#). necrux.com.
2. Henderson, Wes (December 19, 2015). [\(S\)FTP\(S\) or: How I Learned to Stop Worrying and Love File Transfer](#). necrux.com.

3. Henderson, Wes (April 28, 2015). [Understanding and Adopting a Cloud Mindset for your Emerging Business](#). Rackspace.

4. Henderson, Wes (April 28, 2014). [An Overview Of Disaster Recovery And Mitigation In The Cloud For Emerging Businesses](#). Rackspace.

Volunteer Work

Huebner Elementary School

Tech Educator

September 2023 - Present

- Lead classroom 3D printing demonstrations.
- Conduct Internet safety classes.
- Design and print 3D awards/merch for the school.

Wes Henderson — whendersonii@gmail.com — (210) 589-0628